



CARIBBEAN CLIPPER

Handlers offload cargo and mailbags from an S-40 Clipper in Miami. Three S-40s were built, carrying up to 40 passengers each on Pan American's Caribbean and South American routes.

helped stamp the equation "flying boat equals glamour" onto the public consciousness.

Over the next few years, through a combination of shrewd company takeovers and intensive lobbying in Washington, Trippe extended Pan American's control of routes down both coasts of South America and established the company as the single airline representing the United States abroad – the "chosen instrument" of foreign policy.

With longer routes and expanding business, Trippe sought flying boats with a larger payload and greater range. The next to be introduced, developed directly in collaboration with Pan American, was the 40-passenger Sikorsky S-40. The S-40s were the first Pan American airplanes to be called clippers. They attempted to match the romantic name with elegant style, boasting spacious compartments, upholstered chairs, backgammon tables, and hot meals served by a uniformed steward. The romance of the flying-boat service to Brazil was celebrated by

PASSENGERS BOARDING

A Pan American Sikorsky S-42 takes on passengers at Pan Am International Airport, Dinner Key, in Miami, Florida. Probably Sikorsky's finest flying boat, the S-42, introduced in 1934, cut the travel time from Miami to Buenos Aires to five days.

JUAN TRIPPE

ONE OF AVIATION'S VISIONARY EMPIRE BUILDERS, Juan Trippe (1899–1981) was a Yale alumnus and scion of a well-connected New York family. After leaving college he entered the domestic airmail business, setting up Long Island Airways before moving on to Colonial Airways, operating the Boston–New York airmail route. But Trippe's ambitions drew him further afield. In 1925, he secured sole landing rights in Havana from the Cuban dictator General Machado. When the Pan American company won a contract to carry mail between Key West and Havana in 1927, Trippe had to be cut in on the deal. He quickly took charge of Pan American, and with excellent connections in Wall Street and Washington, a showman's flair for publicity, and a gift for the cut-and-thrust of business competition, Trippe built the company into the first worldwide airline. To open up transoceanic routes, he promoted the development of bigger, better flying boats, culminating in the huge Boeing 314. He went on to lead Pan Am through the prop-liner era into the jet age. One of Trippe's last actions before his 1968 retirement was to commit the company to the Boeing 747, a bold decision that defined the shape of modern passenger transportation – and set Pan Am on the path to bankruptcy.



DYNAMIC DUO

In 1927 Juan Trippe hired Charles Lindbergh (above right) to pioneer airline routes to every South and Central American country. Trippe had a gift for spotting new markets. On March 28, 1949, he was featured on the cover of Time.



Hollywood in the 1933 movie *Flying Down to Rio* – in which the S-40 appears occasionally but is upstaged by the first screen pairing of new dancing stars Fred Astaire and Ginger Rogers.

The first S-40s came into service in 1931, but by then Trippe was already looking toward transoceanic passenger routes. Commercial logic suggested starting with the Atlantic crossing, but Pan American ran into stiff resistance from European governments determined that their

national airlines should take an equal share in any transatlantic service. While negotiations about reciprocal landing rights became bogged down, Pan American looked to the Pacific. In 1931 Charles and Anne Morrow Lindbergh, flying the Lockheed Sirius *Tingmissartog*, carried out a route-survey flight to Japan and China via Alaska. But although the Lindberghs showed that the Alaskan route was technically feasible, political instability ruled it out after Japan invaded the

